

AGENTS.md — novus-aexenti Agent Operational Contract

1. Operational Invariants & Rules of Engagement

1. **Locality of Reference**:

- Skills and tools developed for cognitive routing and reasoning must live directly inside `skills/` and `tools/` within this repository. Never export local heuristics to arbitrary global trees.

2. **Non-1:1 Condensation Law**:

- Ingestion and normalization must eliminate conversational filler and duplicate logs, but preserve 100% of technical rules, parameters, models, and build fidelity.

3. **Red Auditor Stealth Invariant**:

- The Red Auditor lives strictly in isolated `~/red/` outside of visible repository trees and manifests. The only valid surface in this repository is the `red\_verdict: pass|fail|n/a` metadata field.

4. **Hard Rule 5 (Extractor Independence)**:

- Any verification pass must use disjoint tools/parsers from those used during initial extraction.

5. **Beginner-Proof Standard (Hard Rule 8)**:

- Any script, config, or routing rule must be structured so that an independent developer or junior model can pick up and execute without implicit assumptions.

6. **First-Move Directive**:

- Always read `MAP.md` before searching or loading files. Never load `manifest.jsonl` whole into context; query and filter it.

2. Reference Pointers

- Invariant Authority: `MAPS/Universal file configuration`

- Architecture Reference:

- `MAPS/PROPOSAL-V2-CORRECTED-WIKI-TERMINOLOGY-AND-s-tier-ALTERNATIVE.md`

- Master Deliverables: `MAPS/A OPERATOR\_MAP.md`